SAN FRANCISCO

Protester arrested for throwing brick during San Francisco Mayor London Breed's chaotic open air drug hearing

San Francisco Mayor London Breed had said city can no longer let drug users and dealers 'get away with murder'

By **Danielle Wallace** | **Fox News**

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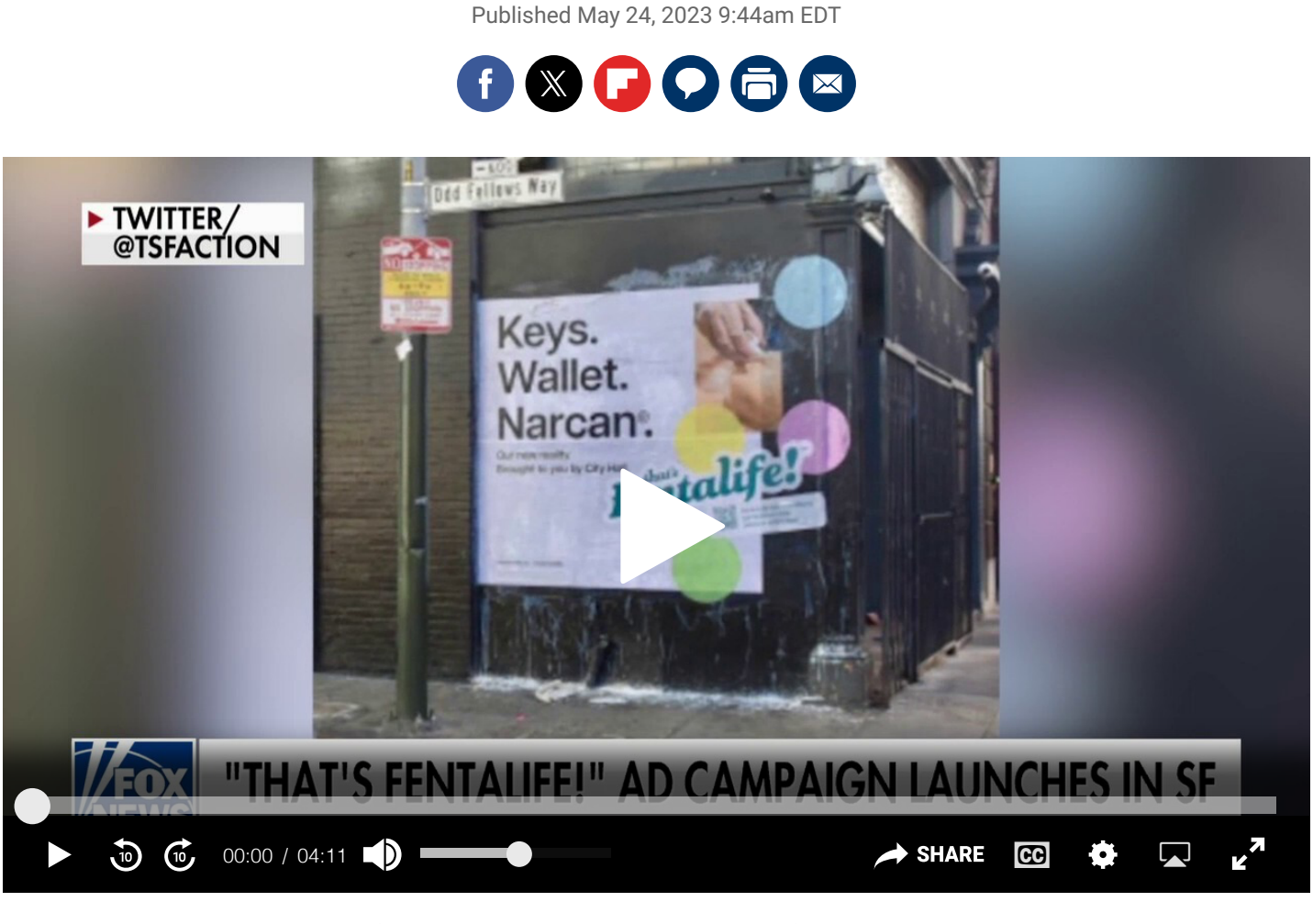

San Francisco residents tired of city's drug crisis launches 'Fentalife' ad campaign

TogetherSF Action member Cedric Akbar discusses the colorful 'That's Fentalife' ad campaign in response to the city's drug 'enablement'.

A protester was arrested for hurling a brick Tuesday during San Francisco Mayor London Breed's chaotic outdoor hearing centered on cracking down on homeless open air drug markets.

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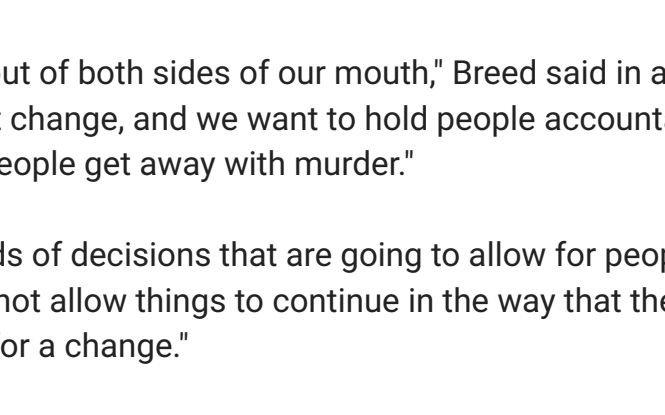
San Francisco Board of Supervisors President Aaron Peskin had decided to move the mayor's regular monthly meeting with the board down the block from City Hall to the United Nations Plaza, which has grown rampant with drug dealing and stolen good sales.

"We can't keep speaking out of both sides of our mouth," Breed said in a fiery five-minute speech. "On the one hand we want change, and we want to hold people accountable, and on the other hand, we're willing to let people get away with murder."

"We have to make the kinds of decisions that are going to allow for people to get the help and support they need, but not allow things to continue in the way that they have for far too long," the mayor said. "It's time for a change."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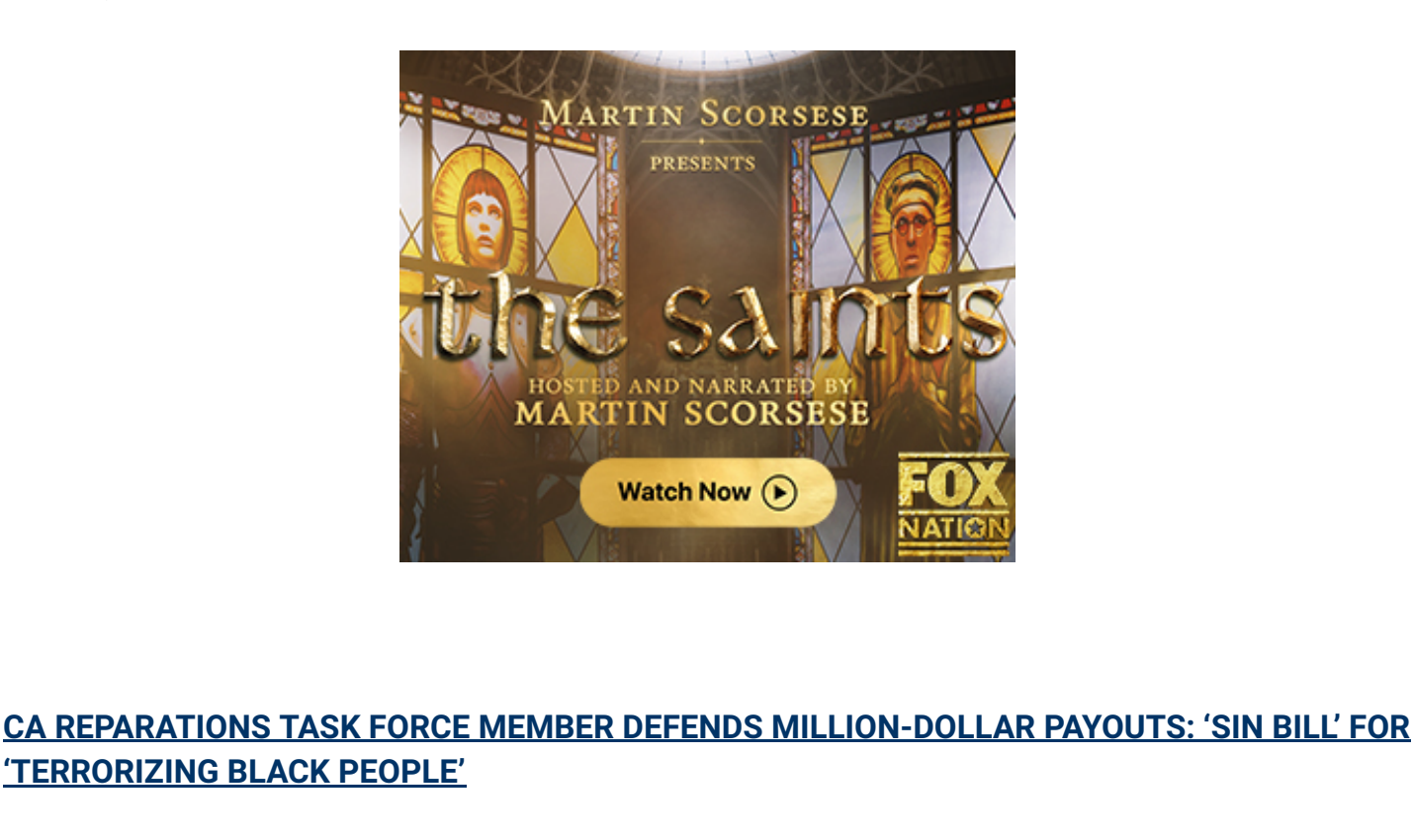
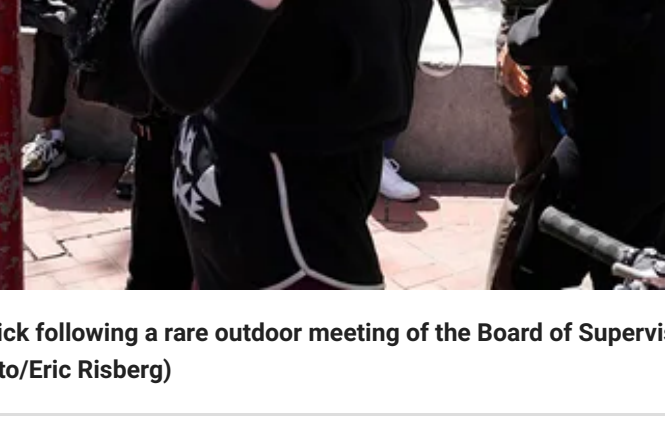


A protester prepares to throw a brick following a rare outdoor meeting of the Board of Supervisors at U.N. Plaza in San Francisco, May 23, 2023. (AP Photo/Eric Risberg)

Peskin started to grill the mayor on a request he had outlined in a letter earlier in the day to establish an Emergency Operations Center for multiple agencies to coordinate response and shut down open air drug dealing sites like the one in the plaza in the next 90 days.

Heckling and chants of "no more cops" from the large crowd were so loud that Peskin moved the meeting back to City Hall before the mayor could answer.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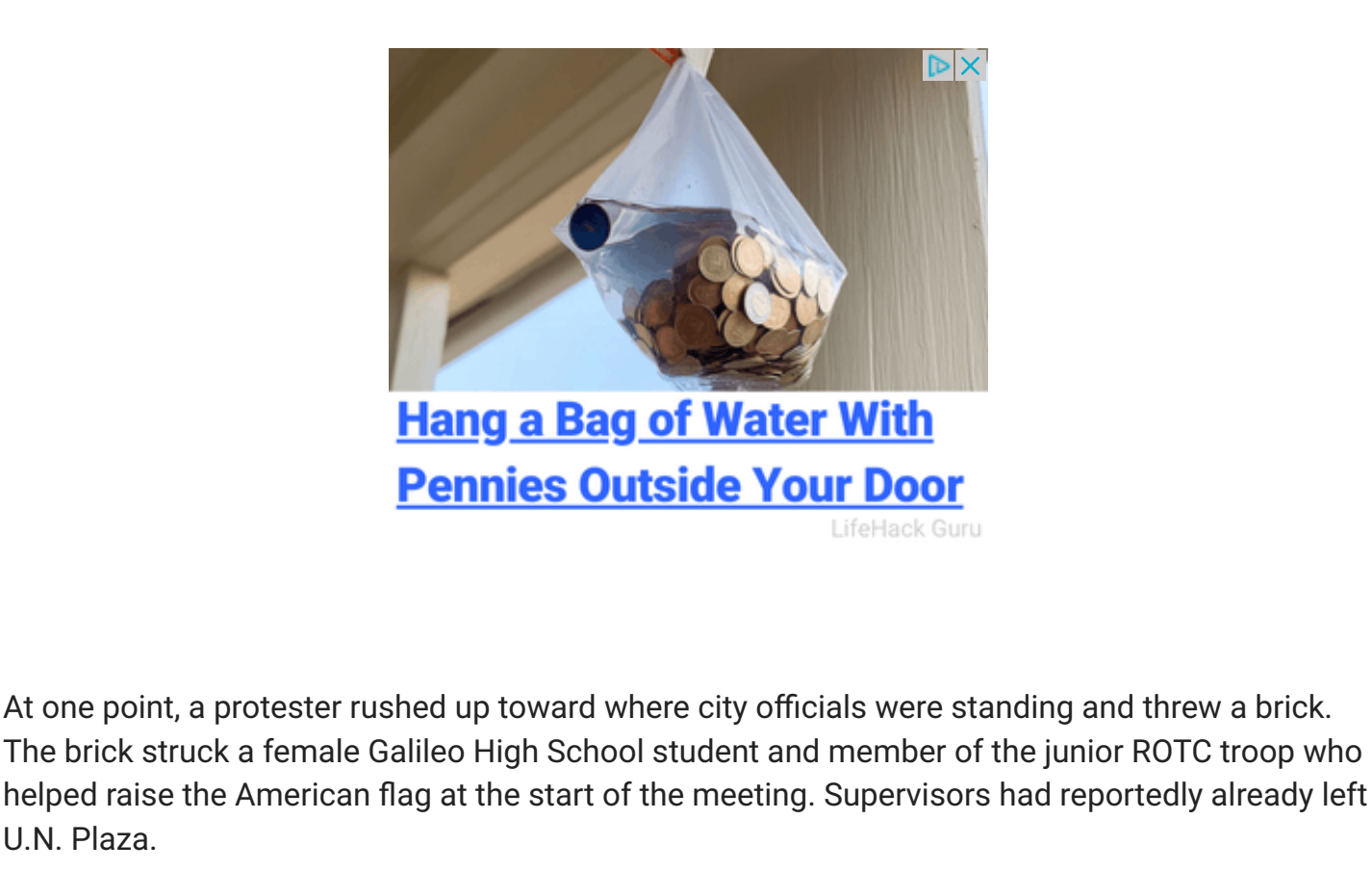
At one point, a protester rushed up toward where city officials were standing and threw a brick. The brick struck a female Galileo High School student and member of the junior ROTC troop who helped raise the American flag at the start of the meeting. Supervisors had reportedly already left U.N. Plaza.



A suspect is arrested after a brick was thrown during a Board of Supervisors meeting at U.N. Plaza in San Francisco, Tuesday, May 23, 2023. (AP Photo/Eric Risberg)

The minor student was not seriously injured, and law enforcement soon detained the protester on the ground.

The San Francisco Police Department later identified the suspect as 26-year-old Elysia Katet, the San Francisco Chronicle and The San Francisco Standard both reported.

Online jail records showed Katet was booked on charges of child endangerment and assault with a deadly weapon.

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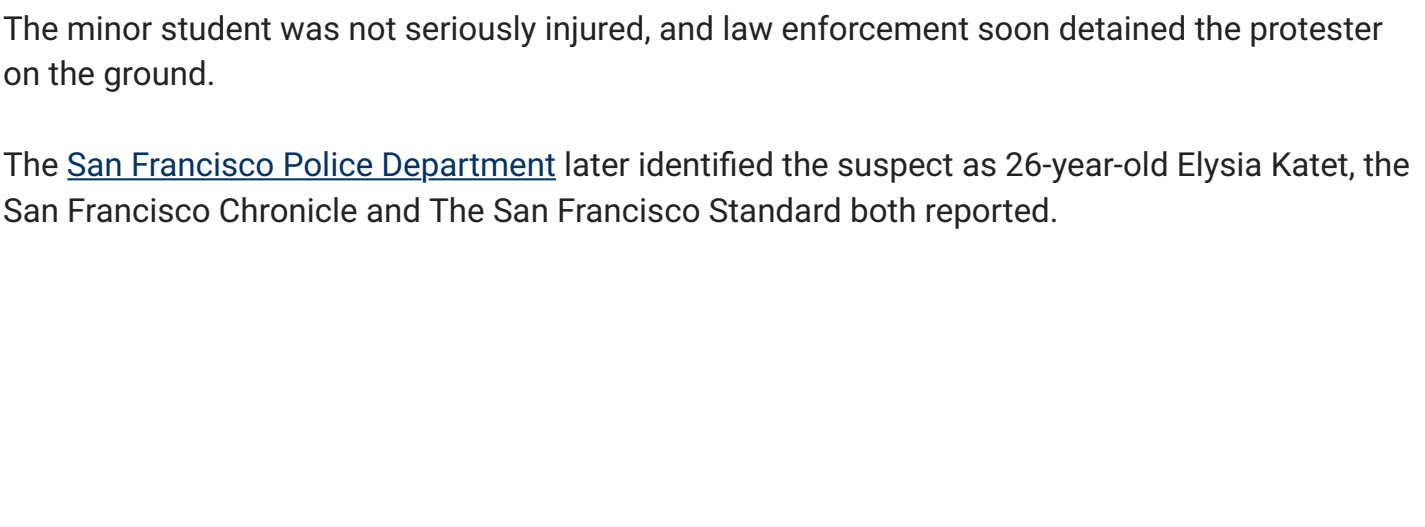
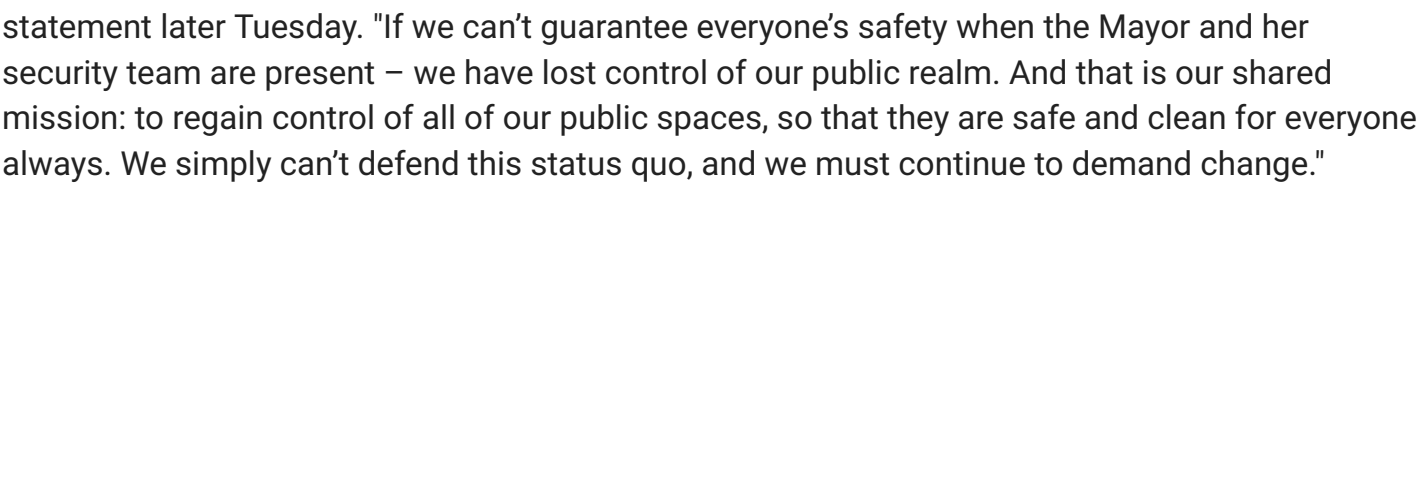


San Francisco Mayor London Breed speaks at U.N. Plaza in San Francisco, Tuesday, May 23, 2023. (AP Photo/Eric Risberg)

"The attack on a young person in the Plaza today when a violent protester threw a brick is only another tragic example of how we are losing control of our public spaces," Peskin said in a statement later Tuesday. "If we can't guarantee everyone's safety when the Mayor and her security team are present – we have lost control of our public realm. And that is our shared mission: to regain control of all of our public spaces, so that they are safe and clean for everyone always. We simply can't defend this status quo, and we must continue to demand change."

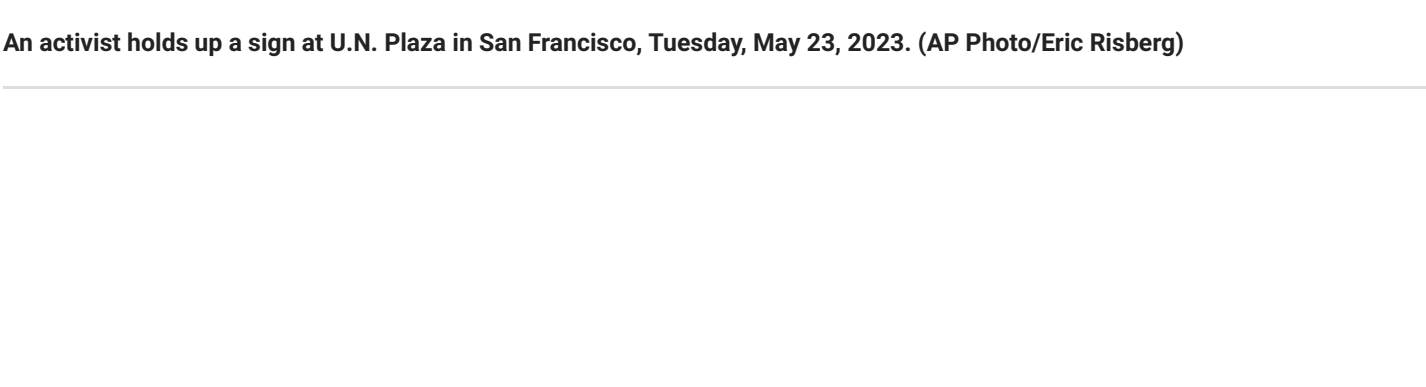
Peskin, a progressive, has argued that the city already has sufficient resources but lacks coordination.



A protester suspected of throwing a brick at a color guard is led away by police at U.N. Plaza in San Francisco, Tuesday, May 23, 2023. (AP Photo/Eric Risberg)

Breed's emergency management department earlier in the day had confirmed a pilot program to allow state law enforcement to intervene in removing people using drugs who are a danger to themselves or others off the streets, which liberal critics condemned as a plan to essentially arrest drug users.

"The people who live here, the folks who work here and the people who experience these challenges every single day, they deserve better," Breed said, according to the Standard. "Why should someone else's rights be put before their needs and their safety and what they deserve, too, in a place like San Francisco that claims to be so compassionate and liberal? What about them?"


LONDON BREED HATES POOR PEOPLE!

An activist holds up a sign at U.N. Plaza in San Francisco, Tuesday, May 23, 2023. (AP Photo/Eric Risberg)

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"I get that people have an issue with the fact that we are looking at being more aggressive with people struggling with drug addiction," the mayor, whose sister died of a drug overdose, added, according to the Chronicle. "I want to make sure that person doesn't die. How do we do that? Force is going to have to be a part of it, whether people like it or not… Compassion is killing people."

The Associated Press contributed to this report.

Danielle Wallace is a breaking news and politics reporter at Fox News Digital. Story tips can be sent to danielle.wallace@fox.com and on X: @danimwallace.

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Earth01
24 May, 2023
San Francisco is soon to become an empty shell with all of the businesses that are leaving and probably won't be fixed for generations to come. This is all because of Gavin's policies allowing anyone to do want they want with zero consequences.
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theblueline
24 May, 2023
I have a friend that attended a conference recently at the St. Francis Hotel downtown. He was warned not to remove his car from the garage and park anywhere on the streets and not to wander about downtown or Union Square, it was too dangerous. Great advice for what used to be a great tourist destin...
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chesterwood
24 May, 2023
It already is. I have friends who live there and tell me the downtown area is a ghost town.
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alpkman1776
24 May, 2023
If only all this was somehow predictable.

"a pilot program to allow state law enforcement to intervene in removing people using drugs who are a danger to themselves or others off the streets, which liberal critics condemned as a plan to essentially arrest drug users."

Yep. That's exactly what it is.... **See more**
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tpvdallas
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Ban Narcan. Provide higher quality opioids. Let nature take it's course. The problem will take care of itself.
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AndAwayWeGo!!!!
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Just ban Narcan and nature *will* take it's course.
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brennenstuhl
24 May, 2023
Should note its good to keep with police still. There've been cases where LEOs have been poisoned by accidental contact with narcotics.

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harve
24 May, 2023

And was the brick among those "mysteriously" delivered on pallets like they were in the cities just prior to the Floyd "peaceful protests" ?

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US🙄versus🙄US
24 May, 2023

That was an old Soros brick from the 2020 riots he funded with his "brick pile drop off" program.

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Justcommonsense823
24 May, 2023

A person throwing a brick is not a protester, they are a criminal and should be jailed, charged with criminal assault. Falls right in there with ‘mostly peaceful’ protests. Criminal action is criminal action, call it what it is.

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rockdude49
24 May, 2023

This racial, political, gender identity, divide the Left has created, along with their radical views on police and soft crime laws, has created a nation of hate and division. This is a very dangerous place for our country to be where politicians have pitted these groups against each other. We must ...

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live2hikefishbike
24 May, 2023

Is there any coincidence that the largest world summit will be there in November? They’re embarrassed by the filth and lawlessness- and scared of losing $$$$. San Fran has fallen

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Badger51
24 May, 2023

You need to meet violence with violence, not words like mostly peaceful. What's scary, Sean Connery in the Untouchables told cities how to win this battle.

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digitalage4wokenbroke
24 May, 2023

A brick is a serious weapon that can kill a person if thrown on the head. Are they going to charge the protestor with attempted murder and terrorism? Not in SF. Nope.

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arkcannon79
24 May, 2023

Exactly, so to all you folks in SF, there’s your problem. Sorry, not sorry.

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ob9543051
24 May, 2023

In Chicago we call bricks alley apples.😎

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pranqster
24 May, 2023

The only reason they are doing this is their tax base is suffering. Money from the state is alloted by sales tax revenues and SF is surely taking a hit on that.

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FIVE-0
24 May, 2023

Yep. They’ve also painted themselves into a political corner. They know they need to bring down the hammer in order to right the city, but they have placated the radicals so much that reversing now will jeopardize their political futures. It’s hilarious!!

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tphillipsone
24 May, 2023

it was a mostly peaceful brick.

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GiveMeLiberty1776
24 May, 2023

Makes me wonder when the city will start banning assault bricks.

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leftyrail
24 May, 2023

this was one of her voters, this is what you get if you don't give them what you promised

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